

M-14 — Data Protection & Confidential Information

What is this about?

What counts as personal data, what the law expects, and what that means for your inbox on an ordinary Tuesday.

The idea, in plain terms

Manoj handles sales admin in Kochi. He wants to finish a report at home, so he forwards the customer contact list to his personal email. Nothing bad happens. It is still a reportable transfer of personal data out of the company. Four rules that cover almost every decision you will face. In Handling Confidential Information: Divya supports the legal team in Bengaluru. She reuses an old slide in a supplier presentation. It still carries the discount structure agreed with a different supplier. Nobody notices in the room. The photograph circulates.

Key things to know

- **COLLECT LESS** — if you do not need a field, do not ask for it
- **USE IT FOR THE STATED PURPOSE** — not for a new idea later
- **KEEP IT INSIDE** — company systems only, never personal accounts
- **DELETE IT WHEN DONE** — old copies are the ones that leak

A simple example

Situation: You want to finish a customer report at home over the weekend. The file has 300 customer names, phone numbers and order values in it.

What to do: Use the company's approved remote access from your own laptop.

Remember

- **Personal data is wider than names** — Number plates, photos, employee numbers and addresses all count.
- **Collect less** — The only perfect protection. A field you never asked for cannot leak.
- **Keep it inside** — Company systems only. Never personal email, USB sticks or chat windows.
- **Delete when done** — Old copies from finished projects are what leak years later.
- **BCC, always** — One CC field exposes every customer address to every other customer.

Inducto Learning & Knowledge — quick reference for M-14. Watch the lesson video for the full explanation; this page is a takeaway, not a replacement for it.